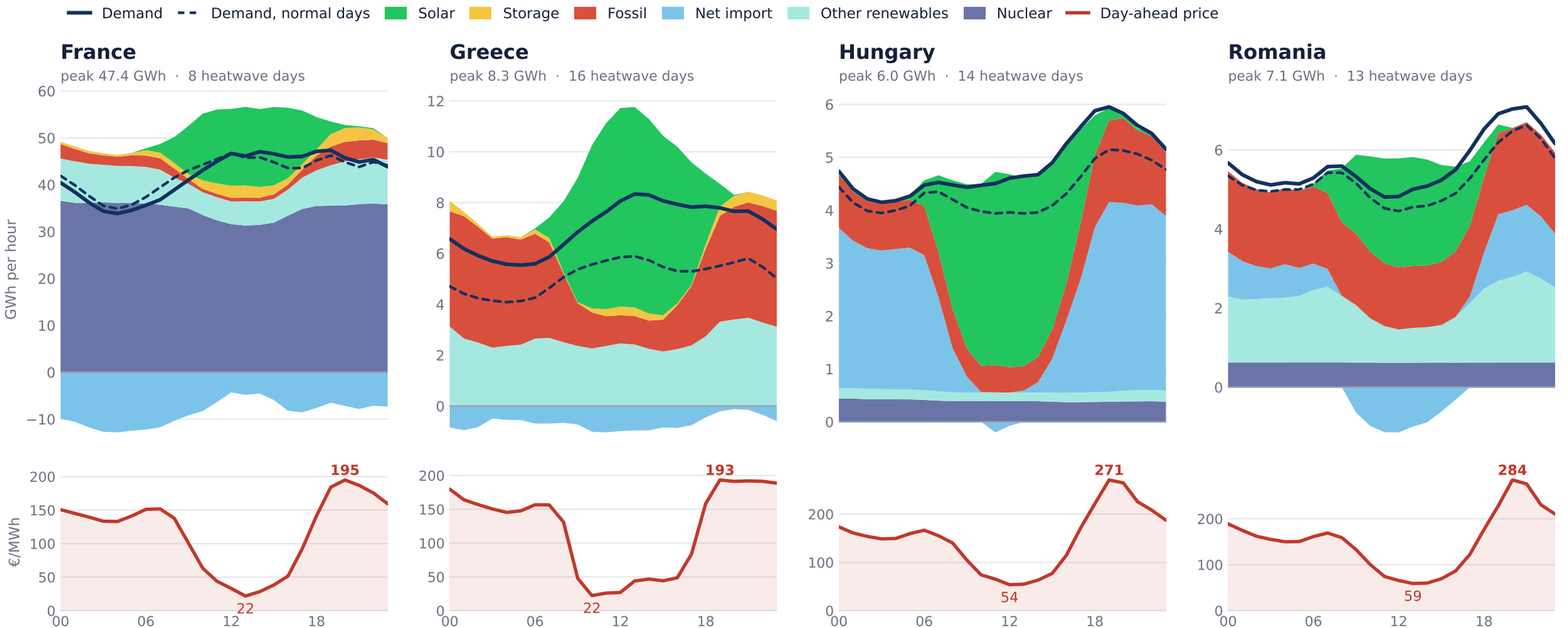
Solar carried the middle of the day; gas carried the evening, and the price followed it

Average hourly generation and day-ahead price during the 28 July – 12 August 2026 heatwave



Solar and storage are drawn at the top of the stack, with fossil directly beneath: the midday solar bulge and the evening fossil surge then read as one handover.

The dotted line is the same hours on non-heatwave days from the same May–September season, weighted to each panel's own mix of weekdays and weekends · the gap between the two lines is what the heat added.

Hours are local, so Greece and Romania (EEST) line up with France and Hungary (CEST). Each panel has its own scale · France peaks near 47 GWh, Greece near 8. The price panel is the same hours and days.

Generation stacks above zero and net exports fall below it, which is why France, an exporter throughout, carries a band beneath the axis.

Storage is discharge only: ENTSO-E publishes pumping separately, and Hungary and Romania report no pumped storage at all. Every interconnector is included, the Balkan and non-EU borders among them · Hungary now balances exactly. Greece's export band is still understated: ENTSO-E reports its Albanian and Italian flows for well under a third of these hours, and an unreported hour counts as none.

Source: ENTSO-E Transparency Platform (generation, load, cross-border flows, day-ahead prices) · ERA5 via Open-Meteo (temperature)